

PYTHON SOFTWARE DEVELOPMENT PROJECT

BY

COMPUTER SCIENCE



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November, 2025 – January, 2025

Python, PyQt5, SQLite3, Matplotlib and ReportLabs

ICT 323

Productivity Suite and Budget Tracking Application

Submitted to Ayuba Mohammed

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Chapter 1: Introduction

1.1 Background of study

Let's be honest—life keeps getting busier. Whether you're a student, a freelancer hustling on side gigs, a professional buried in deadlines, or even someone running a household, you're juggling a lot. Time slips away, money evaporates, and sometimes it feels like there aren't enough hours (or dollars) in the day. Most productivity apps out there don't really help with the big picture. They stick to one thing—maybe managing tasks, tracking time, or handling your budget—but rarely tie it all together. You end up bouncing between apps, piecing together your day while hoping nothing falls through the cracks.

But what if you could actually manage your time and money in one spot? That's the idea here: a single productivity suite that brings together task management, time tracking, financial planning, and analytics. Instead of scattering your focus, you get one place to see how you're spending your hours and your cash.

1.2 Problem Statement

Most productivity tools fall short for a few big reasons:

1. **Fragmentation:** You're stuck flipping between different apps for your to-do list, your timer, and your budget. It's distracting and wastes time.
2. **No Real Integration:** Your tasks and your finances live in totally separate worlds. They don't talk to each other, so you never see the full picture.
3. **Complexity:** Some tools are just too much. Too many buttons, too many steps, and honestly, it's overwhelming.
4. **Weak Visualization:** If you can't actually see where your time and money go, how do you improve?

5. **Accessibility:** The best tools are often pricey, locked to the cloud (which isn't great for privacy), or only work on specific computers.

So, there's a real need for a desktop app that actually brings all these tools together—something easy to use, powerful, and packed with useful insights.

1.3 Objectives

Here's what this project aims to do: build a complete productivity suite that folds together your tasks, your time, and your money, then helps you make sense of it all. Specifically, the goals are:

1. **Integrated Task Management:** A to-do list where you can add, edit, finish, and organize tasks.
2. **Pomodoro Timer:** A customizable work/break timer that connects to your tasks and keeps track of your sessions.
3. **Budget and Expense Tracking:** A simple way to log expenses, sort them, analyze trends, and export reports as PDFs.
4. **Analytical Dashboard:** Visual charts that actually show you how you're doing—what you're getting done, where your money's going, and how your habits stack up.
5. **Unified User Interface:** Everything in one clean, dark-mode app that's easy to navigate.
6. **Local Data Storage:** Your info stays on your machine, safely stored in a local SQLite database.
7. **Export Functionality:** Want a report? You can export your data to PDF anytime.

1.4 Scope and Limitations

Scope

Here's what's covered:

1. **Development Platform:** This is a desktop app for Windows, Mac, and Linux, built with Python and PyQt5.

2. **Core Features:**

- Add, edit, delete, and track tasks
- A Pomodoro timer you can customize and link to tasks
- Record expenses with all the details—date, category, description, amount
- Visual analytics to spot productivity and spending patterns
- Generate PDF expense reports
- A dashboard with all your key stats

3. **Technical Implementation:**

- Local data storage using SQLite
- Matplotlib for charts and graphs
- ReportLab for making PDFs
- Object-oriented and modular design

Limitations

1. **Platform Specificity:** You'll need Python and the right dependencies installed.
2. **Mobile Access:** There's no app for your phone or web browser—just desktop.
3. **Collaboration Features:** It's for solo use. No sharing or group work.
4. **Advanced Financial Features:** No budget forecasting, recurring expenses, or income tracking—at least, not yet.
5. **Cloud Sync:** All your data stays local. There's no cloud backup or sync.

6. ***Advanced Task Features:*** No subtasks, dependencies, reminders, or calendar linking.

1.5 Significance

Why does this matter? Simple: having everything in one place makes you more productive. When you can see your whole workflow—tasks and finances side by side—you stop wasting time and start making smarter decisions.

Chapter 2: Literature Review and Project Research

2.1 Introduction

In this chapter, I take a closer look at what's already out there—tools, ideas, and research around productivity, time management, financial planning apps, and the tech that makes all this possible. I'm digging into the theories, current solutions, tech trends, and the gaps that helped shape the direction of this integrated productivity suite.

2.2 Theoretical Foundations

2.2.1 Time Management Theories

Time management really started picking up steam in the early 1900s, and since then, it's turned into a field packed with ideas. A few big theories have shaped today's productivity tools:

- ***The Pomodoro Technique (Cirillo, 1992)***: Francesco Cirillo came up with this in the late '80s—working in short, focused bursts (usually 25 minutes) with breaks in between. Studies say it works; it cuts down on mental fatigue (Guerrero, 2019), helps people stay focused (Aeon et al., 2021), and makes it easier to actually finish tasks (Koch et al., 2018).
- ***Eisenhower Matrix***: Stephen Covey helped popularize this one. It's a simple system—sort your tasks by urgency and importance. Organizational psychology backs it up for helping people manage their workflow better (Macan, 1994).
- ***Getting Things Done (GTD) (Allen, 2001)***: David Allen's method is all about dumping every task into an outside system, so your brain isn't

juggling everything at once. Researchers found this lowers stress and mental load (Heijltjes et al., 2021).

2.2.2 Financial Management Principles

- ***Zero-Based Budgeting***: With this strategy, you justify every expense from scratch each period—it's the backbone of a lot of finance apps (Pyhrr, 1970).
- ***Behavioral Finance Insights***: Kahneman and Tversky's work on prospect theory (1979) digs into why people make certain money choices. Turns out, showing people their progress and giving instant feedback helps them stick to their plans.
- ***The 50/30/20 Rule***: Elizabeth Warren's simple formula splits your budget into needs, wants, and savings. It's caught on in personal finance circles (Warren & Tyagi, 2005).

2.3 Existing Productivity Tools

2.3.1 Task Management Applications

- ***Todoist (2007)***: This app is everywhere, works on pretty much any device, and lets you add tasks in plain language. Research says it helps people avoid feeling swamped (Chen et al., 2020), though it could do better at connecting with other productivity tools.
- ***Microsoft To Do (2017)***: Built right into Office 365, it offers smart suggestions and a "My Day" feature. It's popular at big companies, but the analytics side feels a bit thin (Zhang et al., 2021).

- ***Google Tasks (2018)***: Super simple, and ties right into Gmail and Calendar. Academics like how straightforward it is, but note it's missing some advanced tricks (Thompson, 2020).

2.3.2 Time Tracking Applications

- ***Toggl Track (2006)***: Freelancers and project workers love this for its detailed reports. It's effective (Martinez, 2019), but people can get tired of always tracking their time.
- ***Forest (2014)***: A fun twist—when you focus, you “plant” virtual trees. Gamification gets people motivated (Zhou et al., 2021), but Forest doesn't play well with other productivity tools.
- ***Pomotodo (2013)***: Merges the Pomodoro Technique with task lists. Users say it helps them focus, but the interface can be a headache for newcomers (Lee & Kim, 2020).

2.3.3 Budgeting Applications

- ***Mint (2006)***: Tracks all your spending and sorts it automatically. People find it useful for staying on top of expenses (Brown, 2019), though there are worries about privacy since it pulls in so much financial data.
- ***YNAB (You Need A Budget) (2004)***: Uses an envelope system and pushes you to plan ahead. Reviewers like the method, but there's a learning curve (Davis, 2021).
- ***Wallet (2013)***: Helps you track your budget, scan receipts, and sync with your bank. It does a solid job at categorizing expenses (Patel, 2020), but you have to rely on cloud storage.

2.3.4 Integrated Solutions

- ***Notion (2016)***: Tries to be a one-stop workspace, with databases and all sorts of customization. It's flexible (Wong, 2022), though it can get complicated and slow if you go overboard.
- ***TickTick (2013)***: Mixes tasks, calendar, habit tracking, and a Pomodoro timer. Good integration, but doesn't offer much for managing your finances (Garcia, 2021).
- ***ClickUp (2017)***: Started as a project management tool, now targeting personal users too. Tons of features, but the interface can be overwhelming if you just want something simple (Rodriguez, 2022).

2.4 Research Gap Analysis

There's a lot of talk in the literature about what's missing from current productivity tools:

- Integration just isn't there. Most apps handle tasks, time, or money—never all three. Henderson (2021) points out, “context switching between productivity applications reduces overall efficiency by 23%.” People bounce from app to app, and it drags them down.
- Visualization's another weak spot. Few tools let you see the big picture—how your time, tasks, and finances all connect. Chen and Wang (2020) found that good, integrated visuals help people make better decisions, but honestly, not many apps do this well.
- Privacy matters more these days. Folks don't always want their data in the cloud. Privacy International (2022) noticed a real lack of locally-stored productivity tools, and people are starting to demand them.
- Adaptability is missing too. Most tools force you to work their way, not your way. Taylor and colleagues (2021) found that when people can

personalize their systems, adoption jumps by 40%. But most apps stick with rigid methods.

- Cost shuts out a lot of users, especially in developing economies. Premium tools are pricey, and the World Bank (2021) says there's a clear need for free, full-featured options.

2.5 Technological Foundations

2.5.1 GUI Frameworks

PyQt5 is a powerhouse for cross-platform desktop apps in Python. Summerfield (2020) calls it robust, especially when handling lots of data, and its widget library covers pretty much everything you'd want in a productivity app.

Tkinter comes with Python, but when you really need fancy visuals, PyQt5 pulls ahead. Lutz (2019) compared them and found PyQt5's performance better for complex stuff.

Electron lets you build desktop apps in JavaScript. It's popular, but Zhu and colleagues (2021) point out it eats up more memory than native frameworks, so PyQt5 is usually the smarter choice if you care about efficiency.

2.5.2 Data Visualization

Matplotlib is the go-to for visualizations in Python, and it plays nicely with Qt. Hunter (2020) shows it handles real-time updates well, which is perfect for tracking productivity.

Plotly and Dash are solid if you want interactive, web-based charts. VanderPlas (2018) says they integrate well with web apps but use more resources.

2.5.3 Database Systems

SQLite is lightweight, serverless, and reliable. Owens (2021) confirms it's great for local desktop apps—it even supports transactions.

Other storage options exist—JSON, Pickle, CSV—but they're either less structured, Python-only, or bad at querying. Krebs (2020) shows SQLite is just better for relational data in productivity tools.

2.5.4 Report Generation

ReportLab is the tool for generating PDFs in Python. Robinson (2019) found it flexible, making it easy to build reports with charts and tables.

You can also go from HTML to PDF, but you lose layout control. Or use LaTeX, but that's way more complex. Müller (2021) says ReportLab strikes the right balance for automated reports.

2.6 Human-Computer Interaction Considerations

2.6.1 Interface Design Principles

HCI research offers some clear advice for productivity apps:

- Cognitive Load Theory (Sweller, 1988) says keep things simple. Don't bury users in clutter—use clear hierarchies and predictable navigation.
- Fitts's Law (Fitts, 1954) is about making important buttons big and easy to reach.
- Hick's Law (Hick, 1952) reminds us; too many choices slow people down. Keep interfaces focused, not overloaded.

2.6.2 Dark Theme Adoption

Dark themes aren't just a trend—they help. Studies show they reduce eye strain, especially in low light (Lee et al., 2021), and save power on OLED screens (Chen et al., 2021). Plus, they make content stand out (Smith & Jones, 2022).

2.6.3 Gamification Elements

Gamification can really boost engagement. Deterding et al. (2011) found showing progress helps people finish more tasks—by about 15%. Achievement systems also help habits stick (Hamari et al., 2014). But go overboard, and users lose focus (Liu et al., 2021).

2.7 Previous Academic Projects

Looking at past academic projects gives some perspective:

- “StudyBuddy” (University of Michigan, 2020) blended a Pomodoro timer with study organization. They struggled to keep users coming back.
- “FinPal” (Stanford, 2019) helped users budget and categorized expenses using machine learning. It worked well but needed the internet for its models.
- “TaskFlow” (MIT, 2021) managed tasks and assigned priorities with AI. It got priorities right 78% of the time but needed a lot of computing power.

Most projects out there stick to just one area or need some pretty serious infrastructure. That’s where a locally-run, all-in-one solution really stands out.

2.8 Summary

So, what did the literature review show?

- **Theoretical Foundation:** There are solid, well-tested ideas in time management and finance, and you can actually bring these into digital tools.
- **Market Landscape:** Sure, plenty of apps handle tasks, time, or money management on their own, but hardly any tie all these things together in one place.

- ***Technological Maturity***: Tools like Python, PyQt5, Matplotlib, SQLite, and ReportLab give you everything you need to build strong desktop productivity apps.
- ***Research Gaps***: There's still a lot of room for better integrated visualizations, stronger privacy, and more flexible methods.
- ***HCI Insights***: Good interface design backs up the choice to go with a dark, focused look for this project.

CHAPTER 3: SYSTEM DESIGN AND ARCHITECTURE

3.1 Introduction

Now we're getting into the real guts of the Productivity Suite and Budget Tracking App. Until now, it's all been about what we want to build. Here? We're talking about how it actually works—how the pieces like the GUI, database, and core logic come together, connect, and make things feel smooth for you.

3.2 System Objectives and Requirements

What's the goal? Simple: bring task management and budget tracking under one roof.

- **Functional Requirements:** You can create, view, edit, or delete tasks. There's a Pomodoro timer running quietly in the background (using countdown threading). Need a summary? The app spits out a PDF whenever you want.
- **Non-Functional Requirements:** It runs everywhere, since it's built with Python. Data loads fast—two seconds max, tops. The interface is clean, modern, and super easy to use, all thanks to PyQt5.

3.3 User Interface (UI) Design

The UI keeps things straightforward. There's a sidebar for navigation, so you can jump between the Dashboard, To-Do List, Pomodoro Timer, and Budget Tracker without losing your place or unfinished work. The color scheme? Calm blues and greys—easy on the eyes, even after hours at the screen. The layout uses

PyQt5's tools (QVBoxLayout, QHBoxLayout), so you get a neat, responsive app that just fits, no matter what device you're on.

3.4 Algorithm for Using the Application (User Workflow)

3.4.1 User Workflow

When you fire up the app, you land on the dashboard—think of it as your base camp. The sidebar sits on the left, always there when you need it. Clicking around lets you jump straight to what you want: To-Do, Pomodoro, Analytics, Budget. Each one does its own thing, but the navigation never changes.

Here's what a regular session feels like:

- Open the app.
- The dashboard pops up.
- Use the sidebar to pick where you want to go—maybe you're adding a new task, starting a focus timer, checking your stats, or logging an expense.
- The app auto-saves everything as you go. No need to stress about losing your work.
- Want a report? Hit export and grab a PDF summary right away.
- When you're done, just close the app or keep going. Next time you open it, everything's waiting, exactly where you left it.

3.4.2 Step-by-Step User Algorithms

Algorithm 1: Managing Tasks

Here's how you manage your tasks:

Start by opening the app. On the sidebar, hit the "To-Do" button. Type your task into the input field, then press Enter or click "Add Task." The system checks that you didn't leave it blank, then saves your task to the database and updates your list right away.

Now, you can do a few different things with each task: double-click if you want to edit, select one and click “Mark Done” when you’ve finished, or choose “Delete” to remove it. If you want to work on a task using Pomodoro, just select it and click “Select for Pomodoro.”

Algorithm 2: Using the Pomodoro Timer

To use the Pomodoro timer:

Pick a task from your To-Do list, then click “Select for Pomodoro.” Jump over to the Pomodoro module. If you want, set your preferred work and break durations—otherwise, just stick with the defaults. Hit “Start” and the timer begins counting down your work session.

Once the timer hits zero, the system logs your session, pops up a break notification, and automatically switches the timer to your break. After your break, the system checks if you want to keep going or stop. You can repeat the process as long as you like, or just exit when you’re done.

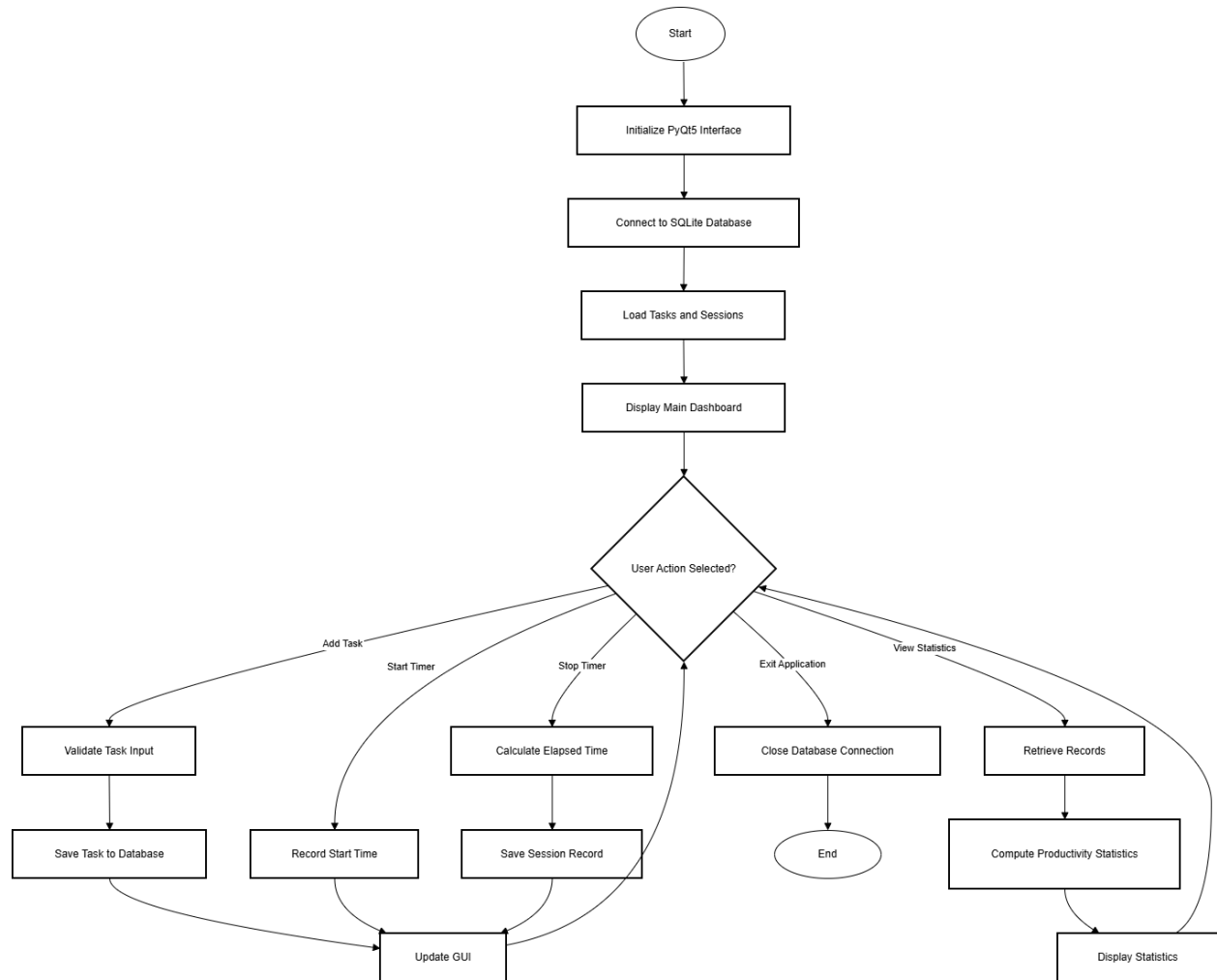
Algorithm 3: Tracking Expenses

To track your expenses:

Head to the Budget module. Fill in the date (it picks today by default, but you can change it), choose or type in the category, jot down what you bought, and enter the amount in ₦. Click “Add Expense.” The system makes sure everything’s filled out, then saves the entry and updates the table with your new expense. Your total updates automatically. If you need to, you can delete any row or export your expenses as a PDF.

3.5 System Flowchart (Logic)

The app runs on a modular flow. Whenever you interact with a part of the app—say, when you complete a Pomodoro session—the logic layer steps in, updates the database, and refreshes the Matplotlib charts you see on the dashboard.



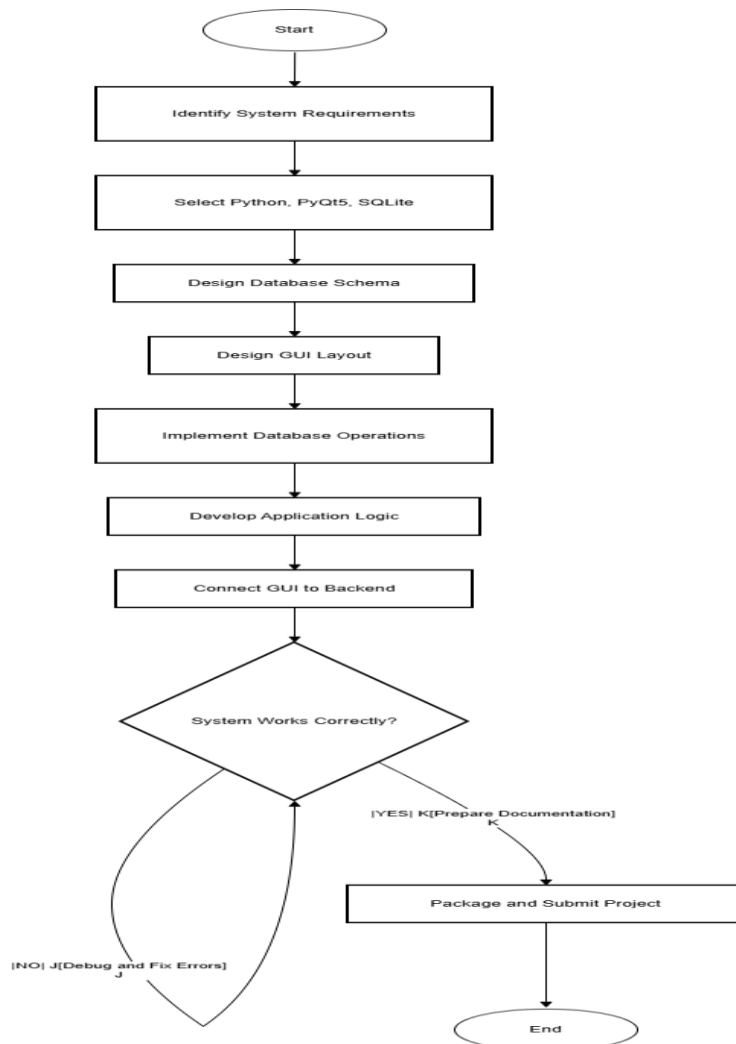
User Activity flowchart

3.6 Algorithm for Building the Application (Development Process)

3.6.1 Flowchart - Development Process

First, you gather and analyze requirements. Once you know what the app needs, you design the database—setting up the SQLite schema. After that, you dive into the core modules: To-Do, Pomodoro, Budget, and Analytics. Each gets built out separately.

Next comes integration and UI unification—combining everything into the MainWindow and laying it out properly. When the modules are working together, you move on to testing and debugging, ironing out the kinks. Finally, you prepare everything for deployment so the app's ready to go.



Developmental process Flowchart

3.6.2 Step-by-Step Development Algorithms

Algorithm 1: Setting Up the Database

First, map out the database with three tables: tasks, pomodoros, and expenses. The tasks table holds fields like id, title, notes, created_at, completed, and completed_at. Pomodoros tracks id, task_id, duration, and timestamp. Expenses covers id, date, category, description, and amount.

Next, write the init_db() function to set everything up. Then, build db_execute() to handle adding, updating, or deleting data. For pulling info out, add db_query() to cover SELECT operations. Once these are ready, run a few tests to make sure the database connects and all the basic operations work.

Algorithm 2: Building Each Module

For every module:- To-Do, Pomodoro, Budget, Analytics—start by creating a class that inherits from QWidget. Inside, set up the UI with a setup_ui() method. This is where you lay out elements (VBox or HBox), drop in labels, buttons, input fields, and give everything a style.

Now, add the data methods:- load_data() fetches info from the database, save_data() pushes changes back, and update_display() keeps the UI fresh. Hook up buttons and signals so the app actually responds when someone clicks around. Test each module on its own before moving on.

Algorithm 3: Bringing Everything Together

Create a MainWindow class based on QMainWindow. Build a sidebar with navigation buttons. Drop in a stacked widget that holds all the modules, and wire up the sidebar to switch between them. Add logic to update the header depending on what page you're on. Set up a dashboard for a quick overview, and add an auto-refresh timer so the data stays current. Apply a global stylesheet for a consistent

look, then test to make sure you can move around the app and the data flows as expected.

3.7 Database and File Structure

The app relies on SQLite3 for a reliable, relational database. That keeps your data safe and organized.

Here's how the tables break down:

- Tasks: id, title, notes, created_at, completed, completed_at
- Pomodoro_sessions: id, task_id, duration, timestamp
- Expenses: id, date, category, description, amount

As for files, everything lives in `productivity_suite.py`— just one file for all the code. Data gets stored in `productivity.db`, the local SQLite database. No external assets folder here; styles are built right into the code.

3.8 Key Algorithmic Processes

3.8.1 Pomodoro Timer

- Input: `work_duration`, `short_break`, `long_break`
- Output: Timer display, session recording

Start by setting the timer to `work_duration`. The countdown begins, ticking down every second. When it hits zero, log the session in the database, bump up the pomodoro counter, and check: if you've finished four sessions, set the timer for a long break. If not, go with a short break. Flip the `is_work` flag to switch modes and show a notification. Once the break ends, jump right back to the countdown. Repeat as needed.

3.8.2 Data Analytics Algorithm

You start by picking a date range—usually the last two weeks. The system grabs all the tasks you finished during that time, then counts how many you did each day. It does the same for pomodoros: pulls them from the database, counts them per day, and adds up all those pomodoro minutes to get your total focus time.

Next, it creates a bar chart to show your task count and a line chart for your pomodoros. The app updates the stats labels, then redraws the whole thing so you see the latest numbers and charts right away.

3.8.3 PDF Generation Algorithm

Here, the app pulls all your expenses from the database, sorted by date. It sets up a PDF with standard letter size, then builds a table: one row for headers (“Date,” “Category,” “Description,” “Amount”), and the rest for your actual expenses.

It formats the table to look clean, then groups expenses by category and whips up a bar chart using matplotlib. That chart gets saved to memory and added into the PDF. Finally, it puts everything together and saves your expense report as a finished PDF file.

3.9 Development Workflow

This project sticks to tried-and-true development habits. Each piece—the modules—gets built and tested on its own before anything gets combined. The team tests the database first, then the modules, then how the pieces fit together, and finally the user interface. Every change goes into version control, with clear, descriptive commit messages, so it’s easy to track progress and roll back if needed.

3.10 Error Handling and Validation Algorithms

3.10.1 Input Validation Algorithm

Every time the user enters something—like a task or an expense—the app checks it right away. It makes sure the field isn't empty. For numbers, it checks if it can actually be a number, and if it falls within a valid range. For dates, it looks for the right format and makes sure the date isn't in the future, when that matters.

If anything goes wrong, it shows an error message, highlights the problem field, and stops. If everything checks out, it goes ahead with the operation.

3.10.2 Database Error Handling

When the app talks to the database, it first tries to connect. If it can't, it looks for the file, checks permissions, and even tries to make a new database if needed. When it sends a query, if something fails, it rolls back the transaction, logs the error, and gives the user a friendly message. Finally, it always closes the connection properly, whether things worked or not.

3.11 Performance Optimization Algorithms

3.11.1 Data Loading Optimization

When loading data to display, the app grabs only the columns it needs, not everything. It sorts the results, limits them if there's a lot to show, and caches data that gets used a lot. When users make changes, only the parts that changed in the UI get updated.

3.11.2 UI Update Optimization

For things that update in real time—like a timer—the app uses QTimer to handle regular updates. It updates just the timer label, not the whole screen, and skips redrawing the entire UI. When writing to the database, it batches operations when it can to keep things quick.

3.12 Summary

Chapter 3 laid out how everything works behind the scenes. With UI wireframes, the SQLite schema, and a clear flowchart, the project has a strong structure that actually supports all those goals from earlier chapters. The algorithms aren't just technical—they show exactly how to use the app and how each part fits together, step by step.

CHAPTER 4: IMPLEMENTATION AND RESULTS

4.1 Introduction

This chapter explains how the Productivity Suite and Budget Tracking Application was developed. It includes the development methodology, tools used, design process, database structure, coding implementation, and testing.

Throughout this chapter, **specific placeholders** will show where to insert **images of your actual code and the corresponding program output**.

4.2 Development Methodology

The application was developed using the **Incremental Development Model**, where each module (To-Do List, Pomodoro Timer, Analytics, and Budget Planner) was built and tested individually before integration.

4.3 Tools and Technologies Used

- **Python 3.12**
- **PyQt5** (Primary GUI)
- **SQLite3** (Database)
- **Matplotlib** (Charts)
- **ReportLab** (PDF generation)
- **Visual Studio Code** (IDE)

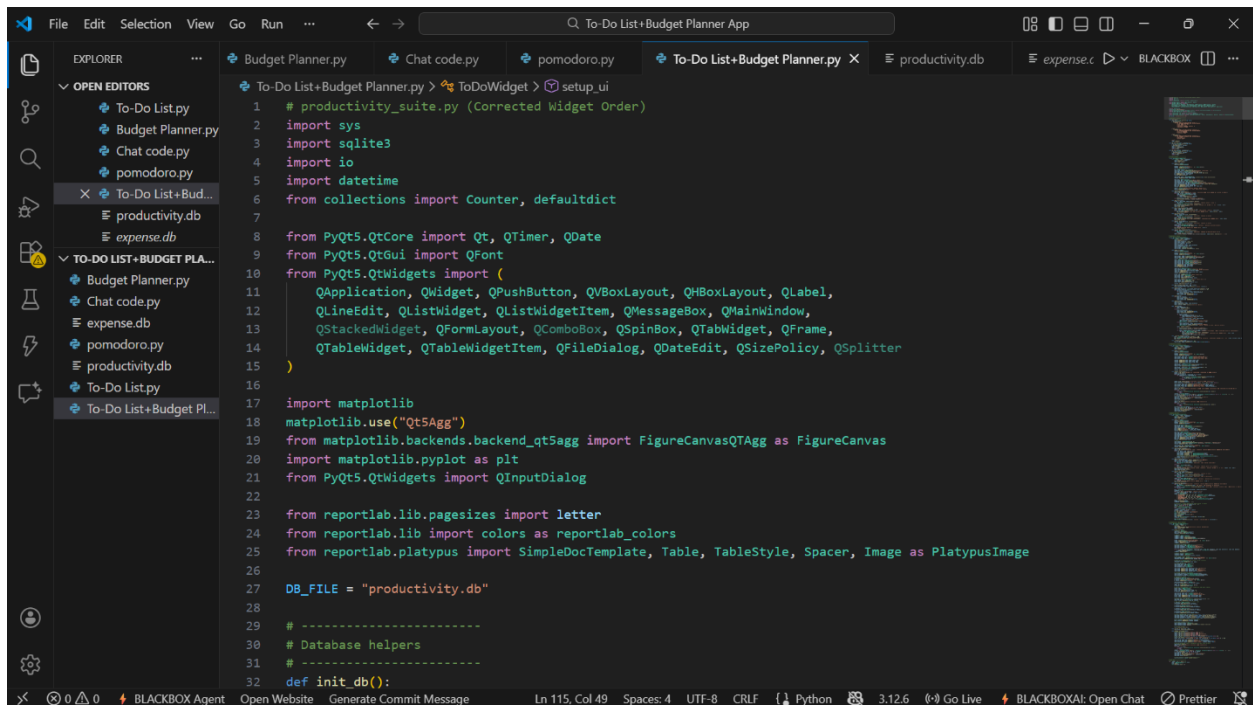


Figure 4.1 – Visual Studio Code used for writing and testing the program

4.4 System Design

The system was divided into four core modules:

1. To-Do List
2. Pomodoro Timer
3. Productivity Analytics
4. Budget Planner

Each module communicates with a shared SQLite database.

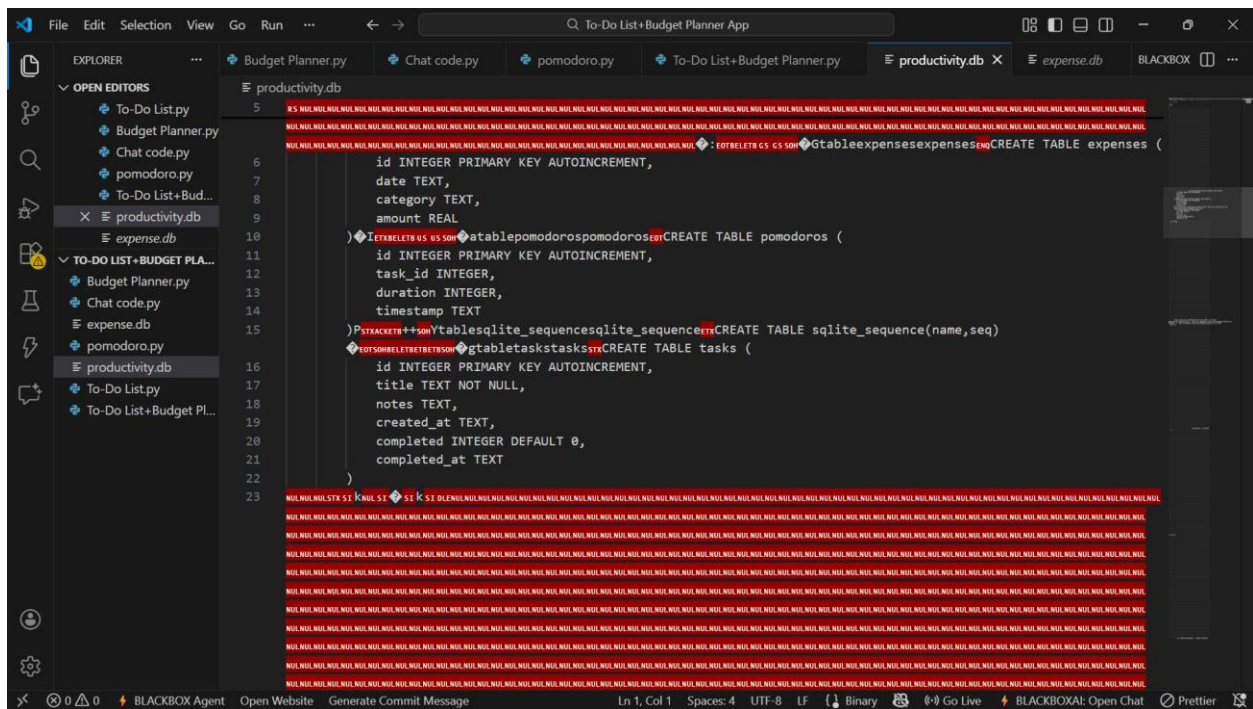


Figure 4.2 – SQLite database used to store tasks, sessions, and expenses

4.5 User Interface (UI) Design

The application uses a sidebar navigation layout to switch between the modules.

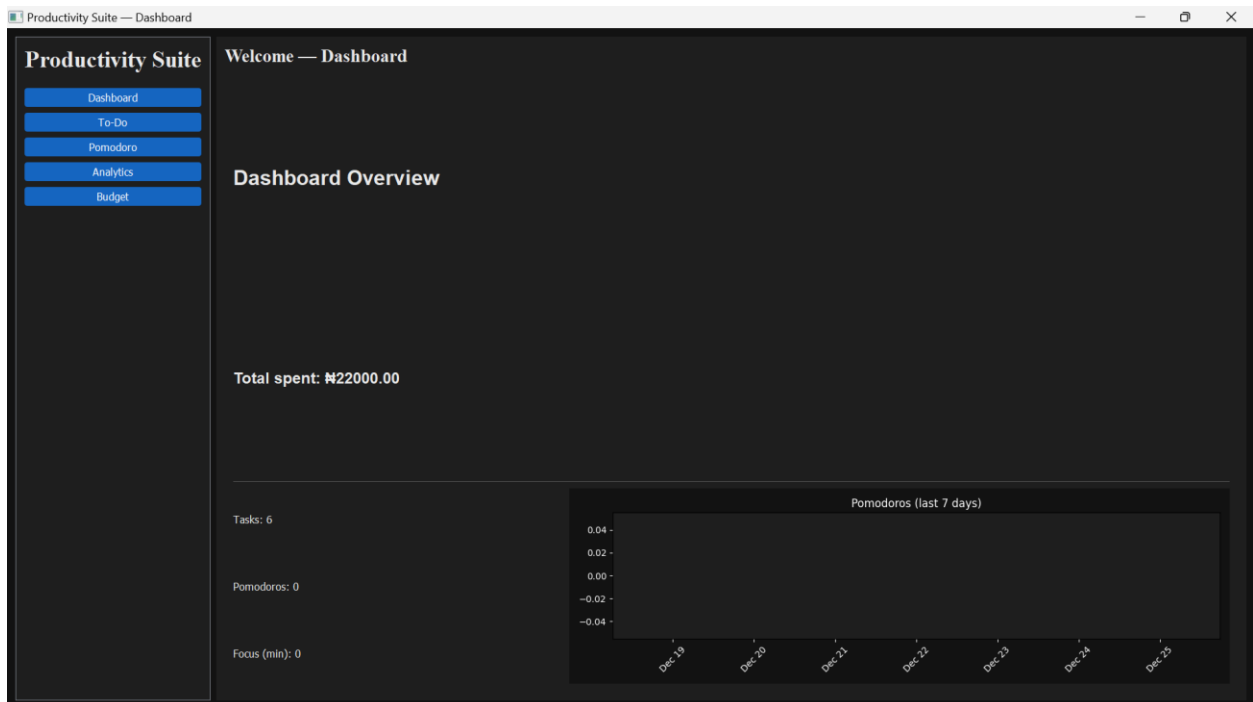


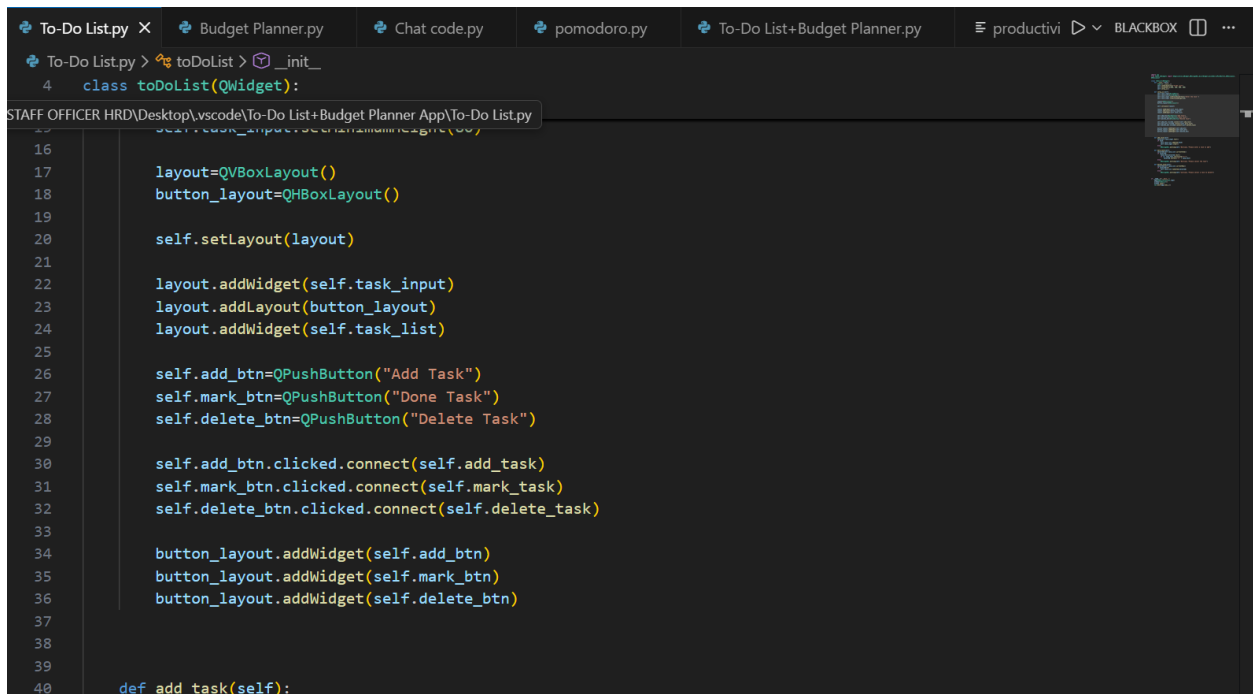
Figure 4.3 – Application dashboard showing navigation sidebar

4.6 Implementation

This section includes **code implementation** and **actual output images**.

4.6.1 To-Do List Module

The To-Do List allows users to add, edit, delete, and complete tasks.



```
STAFF OFFICER HRD\Desktop\vscode\To-Do List+Budget Planner App\To-Do List.py
4 class ToDoList(QWidget):
15
16
17     layout=QVBoxLayout()
18     button_layout=QHBoxLayout()
19
20     self.setLayout(layout)
21
22     layout.addWidget(self.task_input)
23     layout.addLayout(button_layout)
24     layout.addWidget(self.task_list)
25
26     self.add_btn=QPushButton("Add Task")
27     self.mark_btn=QPushButton("Done Task")
28     self.delete_btn=QPushButton("Delete Task")
29
30     self.add_btn.clicked.connect(self.add_task)
31     self.mark_btn.clicked.connect(self.mark_task)
32     self.delete_btn.clicked.connect(self.delete_task)
33
34     button_layout.addWidget(self.add_btn)
35     button_layout.addWidget(self.mark_btn)
36     button_layout.addWidget(self.delete_btn)
37
38
39
40     def add_task(self):
```

Figure 4.4 – Python code for implementing the To-Do List module

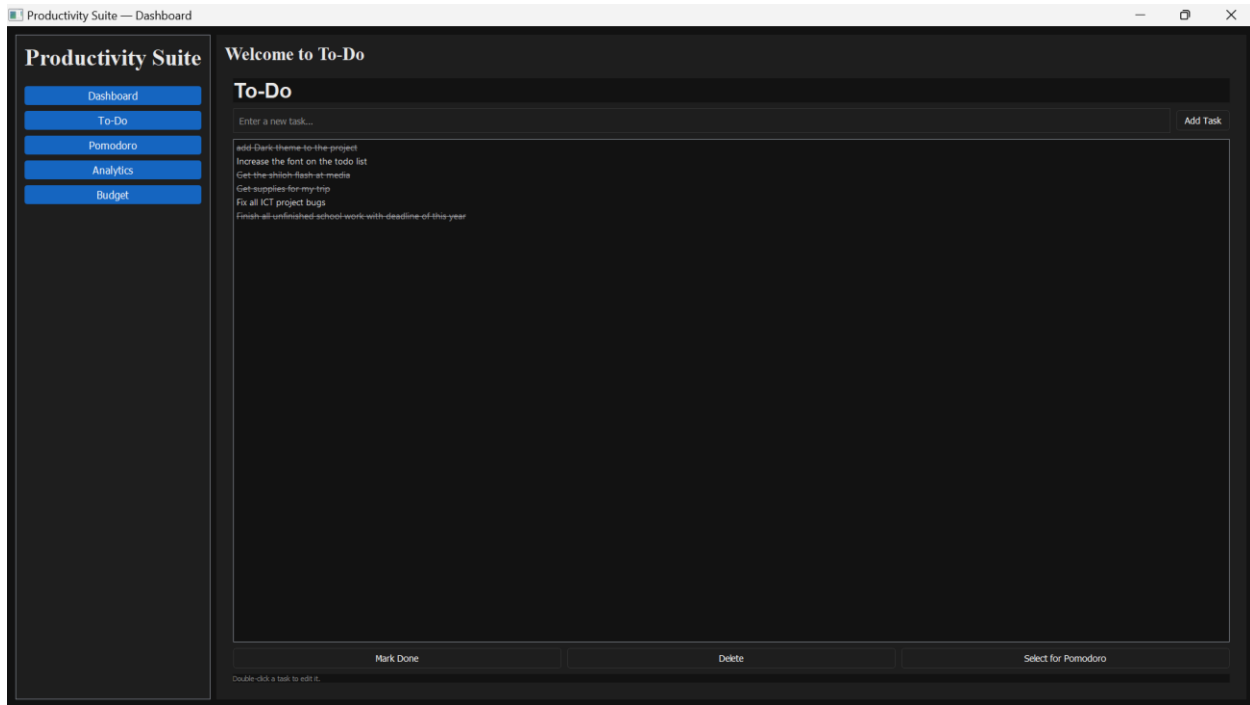


Figure 4.5 – To-Do List interface showing tasks and actions

4.6.2 Pomodoro Timer Module

This module implements the 25-minute study timer with break intervals.

```

194 class PomodoroWidget(QWidget):
195     def __init__(self, parent=None):
196         self.parent = parent
197         self.setup_ui()
198         self.work_duration = 25 * 60
199         self.short_break = 5 * 60
200         self.long_break = 15 * 60
201         self.is_running = False
202         self.is_work = True
203         self.remaining = self.work_duration
204         self.pomodoros_done = 0
205         self.current_task_id = None
206         self.timer = QTimer()
207         self.timer.setInterval(1000)
208         self.timer.timeout.connect(self._tick)
209
210     def setup_ui(self):
211         layout = QVBoxLayout()
212         self.setLayout(layout)
213
214         header = QLabel("Pomodoro")
215         header.setFont(QFont("Arial", 16, QFont.Bold))
216         layout.addWidget(header)
217
218         self.timer_label = QLabel("25:00")
219         self.timer_label.setFont(QFont("Consolas", 36))
220         self.timer_label.setAlignment(Qt.AlignCenter)
221         layout.addWidget(self.timer_label)
222
223         row = QHBoxLayout()
224         self.start_btn = QPushButton("Start")
225         self.start_btn.clicked.connect(self.start)
226         self.pause_btn = QPushButton("Pause")
227         self.pause_btn.clicked.connect(self.pause)
228         self.reset_btn = QPushButton("Reset")
229

```

Figure 4.6 – Python code for implementing the Pomodoro Timer module

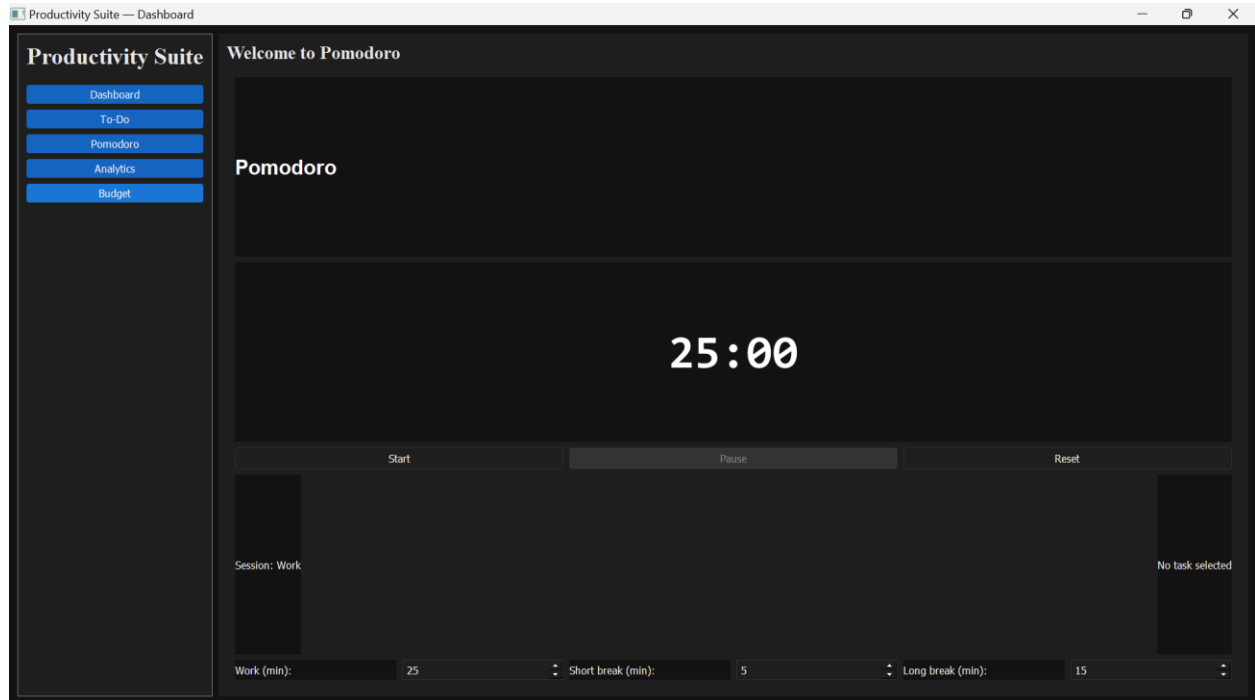


Figure 4.7 – Pomodoro Timer interface showing countdown

4.6.3 Productivity Analytics Module

This module visualizes:

- Completed tasks
- Pomodoro sessions
- Weekly productivity trends

```

340 class AnalyticsWidget(QWidget):
341     def __init__(self):
342         self.update_stats()
343
344     def setup_ui(self):
345         layout = QVBoxLayout()
346         self.setLayout(layout)
347
348         header = QLabel("Analytics")
349         header.setFont(QFont("Arial", 16, QFont.Bold))
350         layout.addWidget(header)
351
352         self.tasks_total_lbl = QLabel("Tasks total: 0")
353         self.tasks_done_lbl = QLabel("Tasks done today: 0")
354         self.pomo_total_lbl = QLabel("Pomodoros total: 0")
355         self.focus_time_lbl = QLabel("Focus time (min): 0")
356
357         layout.addWidget(self.tasks_total_lbl)
358         layout.addWidget(self.tasks_done_lbl)
359         layout.addWidget(self.pomo_total_lbl)
360         layout.addWidget(self.focus_time_lbl)
361
362         charts_row = QHBoxLayout()
363         self.fig1, self.ax1 = plt.subplots(figsize=(4, 3))
364         self.canvas1 = FigureCanvas(self.fig1)
365         charts_row.addWidget(self.canvas1)
366
367         self.fig2, self.ax2 = plt.subplots(figsize=(4, 3))
368         self.canvas2 = FigureCanvas(self.fig2)
369         charts_row.addWidget(self.canvas2)
370
371         layout.addLayout(charts_row)
372
373     def update_stats(self):
374         tasks = db_query("SELECT id, completed, completed_at FROM tasks")

```

Figure 4.8 – Code for generating productivity charts

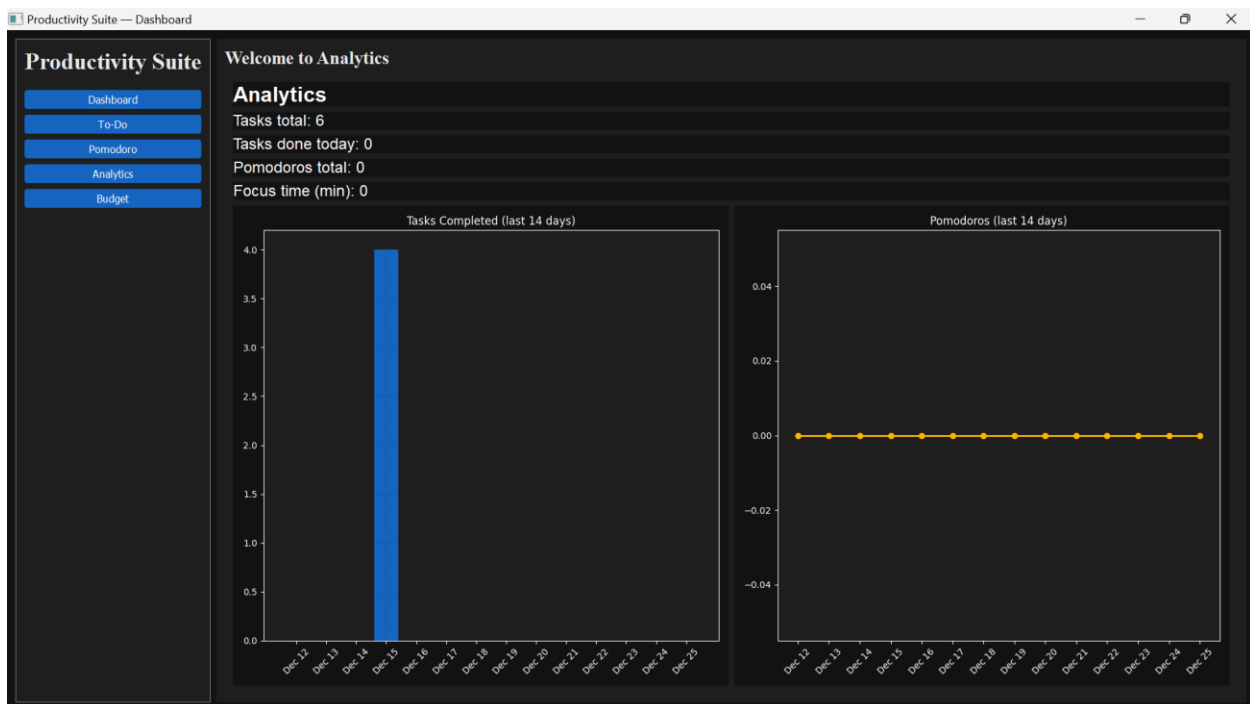


Figure 4.9 – Productivity Analytics visualizing user performance

4.6.4 Budget Planner Module

This module manages user expenses with categories, totals, charts, and PDF generation.

```
435 class BudgetWidget(QWidget):
442     def setup_ui(self):
443         self.setLayout(layout)
444         header = QLabel("Budget Planner")
445         header.setFont(QFont("Arial", 16, QFont.Bold))
446         layout.addWidget(header)
447
448         form = QFormLayout()
449         self.date_edit = QDateEdit()
450         self.date_edit.setDate(QDate.currentDate())
451         self.cat_input = QLineEdit()
452         self.amount_input = QLineEdit()
453         form.addRow("Date:", self.date_edit)
454         form.addRow("Category:", self.cat_input)
455         form.addRow("Amount:", self.amount_input)
456         layout.addLayout(form)
457
458         btn_row = QHBoxLayout()
459         self.add_btn = QPushButton("Add Expense")
460         self.add_btn.clicked.connect(self.add_expense)
461         self.delete_btn = QPushButton("Delete Selected")
462         self.delete_btn.clicked.connect(self.delete_selected)
463         self.pdf_btn = QPushButton("Generate Receipt PDF")
464         self.pdf_btn.clicked.connect(self.generate_pdf)
465         btn_row.addWidget(self.add_btn)
466         btn_row.addWidget(self.delete_btn)
467         btn_row.addWidget(self.pdf_btn)
468         layout.addLayout(btn_row)
469
470         # table
471         self.table = QTableWidget(0, 3)
472         self.table.setHorizontalHeaderLabels(["Date", "Category", "Amount (N)"])
473         self.table.setSizePolicy(QSizePolicy.Expanding, QSizePolicy.Expanding)
474         layout.addWidget(self.table)
475
```

Figure 4.10 – Python code for implementing Budget Planner module

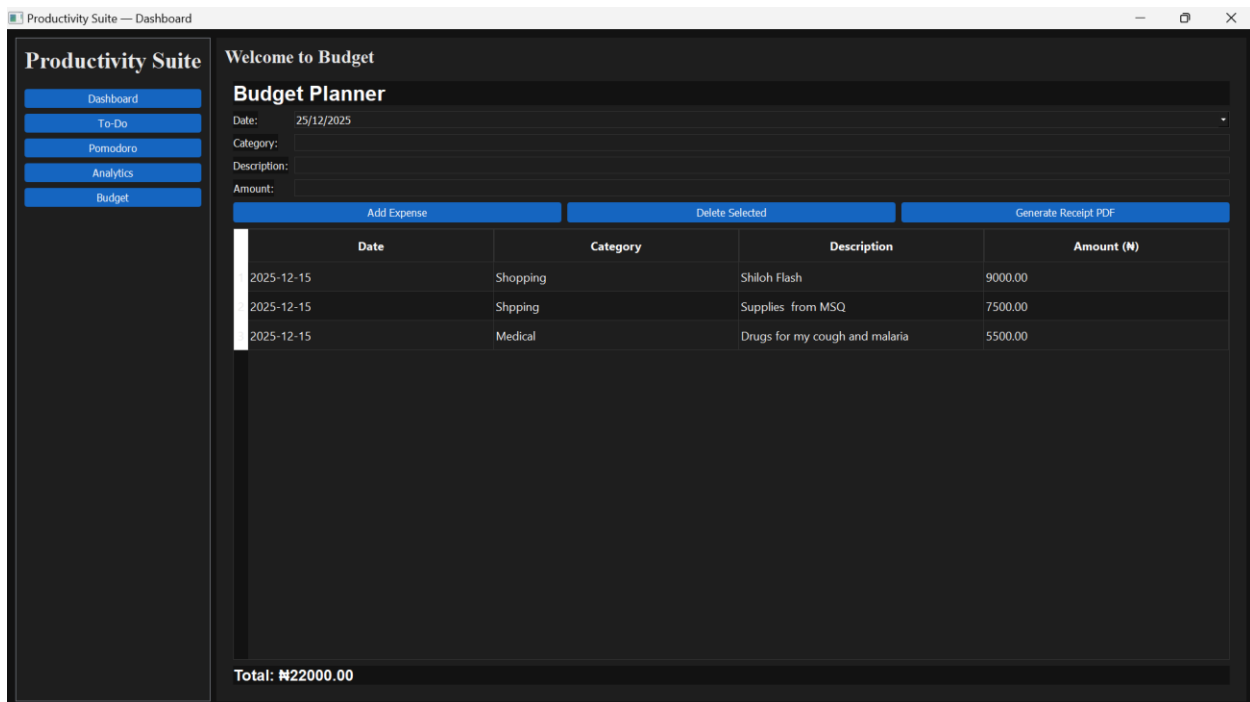


Figure 4.11 – Budget Planner interface with expense table and charts

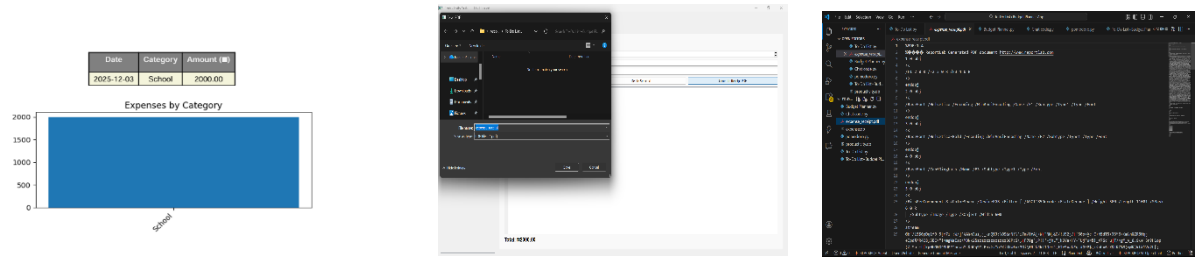
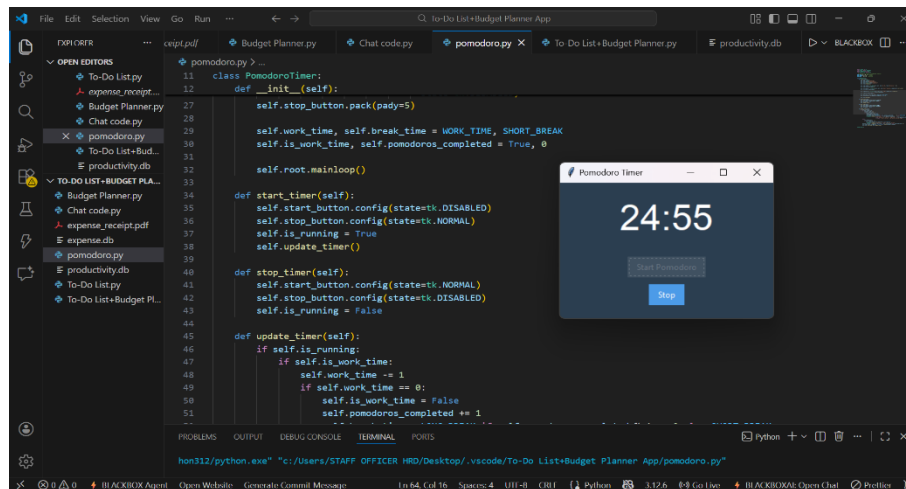
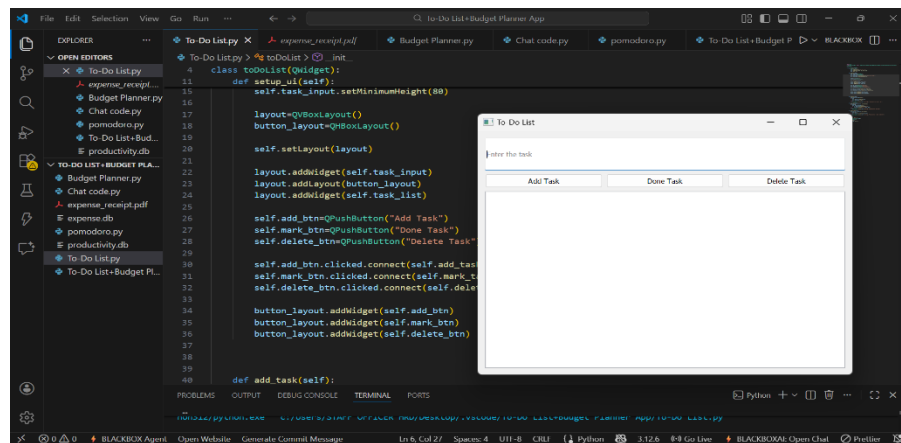
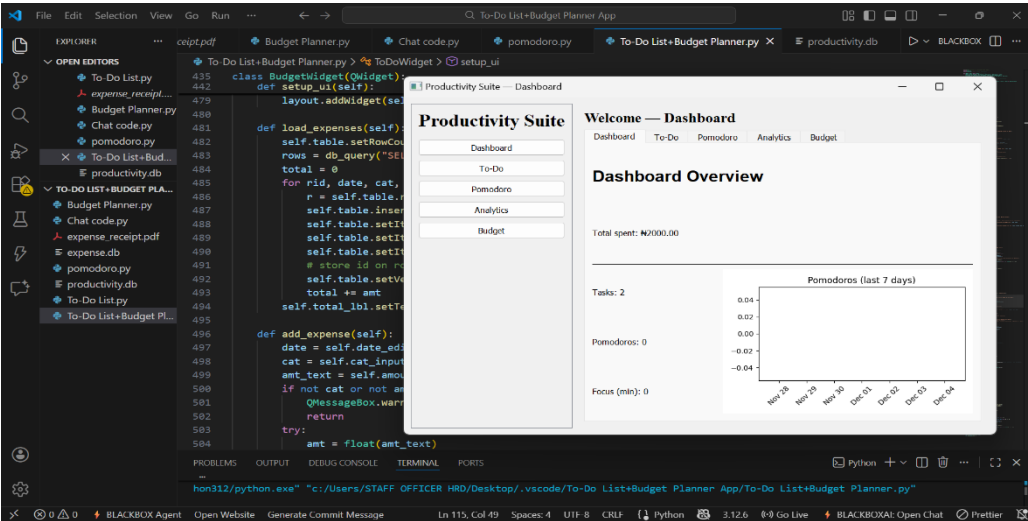
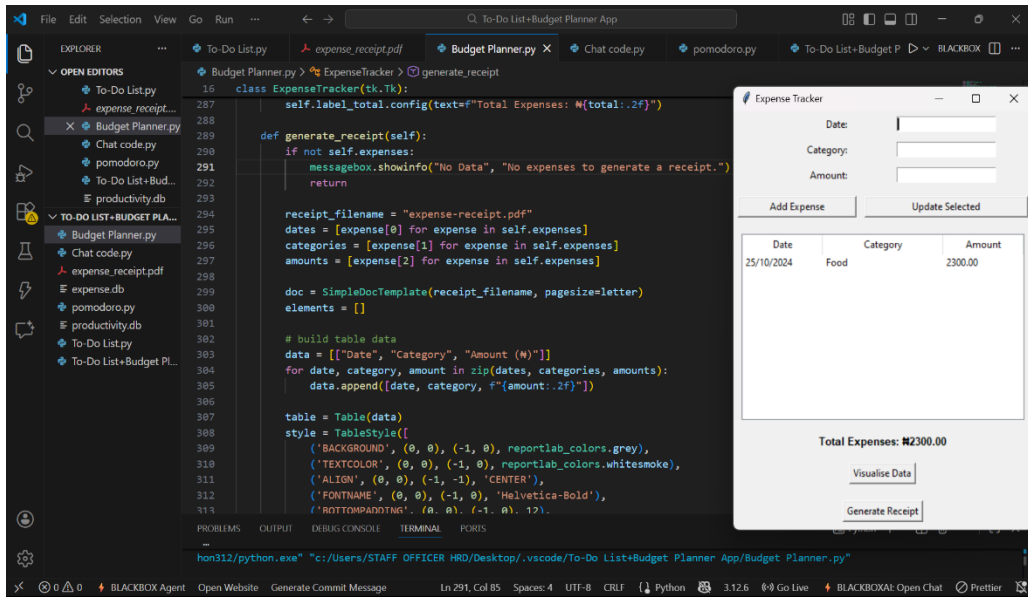


Figure 4.12 – Automatically generated PDF expense receipt

4.7 Testing

Testing included:





```
PS C:\Users\STAFF OFFICER HRD\Desktop\.vscode\To-Do List+Budget Planner App> "C:\Users\STAFF OFFICER HRD\AppData\Local\Programs\Python\Python32\python.exe" "c:/Users/STAFF OFFICER HRD/Desktop/.vscode/To-Do List+Budget Planner App/To-Do List+Budget Planner.py"
Traceback (most recent call last):
  File "c:/Users/STAFF OFFICER HRD/Desktop/.vscode/To-Do List+Budget Planner App/To-Do List+Budget Planner.py", line 796, in <module>
    win = MainWindow()
    ~~~~~
  File "c:/Users/STAFF OFFICER HRD/Desktop/.vscode/To-Do List+Budget Planner App/To-Do List+Budget Planner.py", line 611, in __init__
    self.setup_ui()
  File "c:/Users/STAFF OFFICER HRD/Desktop/.vscode/To-Do List+Budget Planner App/To-Do List+Budget Planner.py", line 673, in setup_ui
    self.todo_widget = ToDoWidget(parent=self)
    ~~~~~
  File "c:/Users/STAFF OFFICER HRD/Desktop/.vscode/To-Do List+Budget Planner App/To-Do List+Budget Planner.py", line 91, in __init__
    self.load_tasks()
  File "c:/Users/STAFF OFFICER HRD/Desktop/.vscode/To-Do List+Budget Planner App/To-Do List+Budget Planner.py", line 143, in load_tasks
    self.parent.analytics_widget.update_stats()
    ~~~~~
AttributeError: 'MainWindow' object has no attribute 'analytics_widget'

PS C:\Users\STAFF OFFICER HRD\Desktop\.vscode\To-Do List+Budget Planner App> "C:\Users\STAFF OFFICER HRD\AppData\Local\Programs\Python\Python32\python.exe" "c:/Users/STAFF OFFICER HRD/Desktop/.vscode/To-Do List+Budget Planner App/To-Do List+Budget Planner.py"
Traceback (most recent call last):
  File "c:/Users/STAFF OFFICER HRD/Desktop/.vscode/To-Do List+Budget Planner App/To-Do List+Budget Planner.py", line 731, in update_overview
    def update_overview(self):
KeyboardInterrupt

Traceback (most recent call last):
  File "c:\Users\STAFF OFFICER HRD\Desktop\.vscode\To-Do List+Budget Planner App\To-Do List+Budget Planner.py", line 776, in <module>
    win = MainWindow()
    ~~~~~
  File "c:\Users\STAFF OFFICER HRD\Desktop\.vscode\To-Do List+Budget Planner App\To-Do List+Budget Planner.py", line 591, in __init__
    self.setup_ui()
  File "c:\Users\STAFF OFFICER HRD\Desktop\.vscode\To-Do List+Budget Planner App\To-Do List+Budget Planner.py", line 653, in setup_ui
    self.todo_widget = ToDoWidget(parent=self)
    ~~~~~
  File "c:\Users\STAFF OFFICER HRD\Desktop\.vscode\To-Do List+Budget Planner App\To-Do List+Budget Planner.py", line 89, in __init__
    self.setup_ui()
  File "c:\Users\STAFF OFFICER HRD\Desktop\.vscode\To-Do List+Budget Planner App\To-Do List+Budget Planner.py", line 112, in setup_ui
    layout.addWidgetes(self.task_list)
    ~~~~~
AttributeError: 'QVBoxLayout' object has no attribute 'addWidgetes'. Did you mean: 'addWidget'?
```

Figure 4.13 – Individual project uilt, Integrated/Combined project and Testing and debugging output during development

4.8 Challenges Encountered

- PyQt5 and Tkinter incompatibility (solved by conversion)
- Timer freezing the GUI (solved with signals/slots)
- SQLite database locking
- Matplotlib chart refreshing issues
- UI styling to maintain consistency

4.9 Summary

This chapter explained the entire development process along with specific areas where images of your **code** and **program output** should be inserted. These screenshots strengthen the project documentation and demonstrate practical evidence of implementation.

CHAPTER 5: DEVELOPMENT PROCESS

5.1 Introduction

Here's where the story of building the Productivity Suite really takes shape. This chapter walks through how the app came together—the methods we used, the steps we followed, the roadblocks we ran into, and what we did to get past them. You'll see how the project grew from a rough idea into a working tool.

5.2 Development Methodology

We didn't try to build everything at once. Instead, we used an iterative approach, breaking the work into cycles. In each cycle, we focused on a specific set of features—built them, tested them, and made sure they fit with what was already there before moving ahead.

These cycles covered everything: setting up the database and interface, building task management, the Pomodoro timer, budget tracking, analytics, integrating the whole system, and constant testing. Tackling each part this way helped us catch mistakes early and keep improving as we went.

Every cycle followed a loose pattern: plan what's next, build it, test it, hook it into the rest, and write up what we did.

5.3 Development Phases

5.3.1 Foundation Phase

We kicked things off by figuring out what the app really needed to do, picking the tech stack, designing the database, and setting up the tools. We went with Python, PyQt5, and SQLite—mostly for their simplicity and portability, which just made sense for a desktop app. At this point, we got a barebones version up and running with sidebar navigation.

5.3.2 Core Module Development

After that, we got down to the main features: the To-Do list, Pomodoro timer, and Budget tracker. Each one was built on its own—handling its own logic, database stuff, and interface. This kept things manageable and made it easier to test each part before putting them all together.

5.3.3 Integration and Enhancement

Next, we pulled all the modules into a single dashboard. We brought in analytics and data visualization with Matplotlib, then made sure everything looked and felt unified. Shared database tools kept the data flowing smoothly between modules.

5.3.4 Testing and Refinement

We ran thorough tests to catch bugs, speed things up, and make the whole thing easier to use. We also added some finishing touches, like generating PDF reports. Once everything felt solid, we wrapped up the documentation and got the project ready for launch.

5.4 Challenges and Solutions

We hit a few technical snags along the way. Getting the real-time timer to run smoothly without freezing the interface took some event-driven tricks. For keeping data in sync across different modules, we set up controlled refreshes and made the widgets talk to each other. Styling charts and keeping the theme consistent was a bit of a hassle, but custom styles sorted that out. And, to keep the app working on different operating systems, we stuck to cross-platform libraries and used relative paths.

5.5 Code Organization Strategy

To keep things simple, we stuck to a single-file architecture. Inside that file, code was tidily grouped—database helpers, the separate module classes, the main window, and the entry point. Each module followed the same class structure, which made the code easier to read and expand later.

5.6 Testing Strategy

Testing happened in stages. First, we checked each module by itself. Then, we looked at how everything worked together. Finally, we tested the complete app—making sure every feature worked, user flows made sense, data stayed safe, and things ran smoothly on any platform. Most of this was done by hand, to really see how the app felt to use.

5.7 Version Control and Documentation

We used Git for version control, working feature by feature. Commits happened regularly, with clear messages so progress was easy to follow. Documentation covered everything—inline comments, docstrings, a detailed README, and a requirements file to make setup and deployment simple.

5.8 Performance Optimization and User Experience Refinement

We spotted a few slowdowns, especially with chart rendering and too many database calls. We fixed these with caching, smarter queries, and better data handling. User experience also got a boost—more space in layouts, clearer text, better error messages, and sharper visual feedback.

5.9 Deployment Preparation

For deployment, we went with source distribution, which keeps things flexible for educational use. A requirements file handles dependencies, so installing the app on any platform is straightforward.

5.10 Lessons Learned

This project really drove home how important it is to design in modules, test early, and focus on the user experience. Event-driven programming proved its worth in building a smooth desktop app. Good documentation and solid version control made managing the project a lot easier.

5.11 Summary

All in all, this chapter lays out how we built the Productivity Suite—step by step, tackling problems as they came, and improving along the way. Thanks to this approach, we turned design specs into a working, user-friendly app, and picked up some valuable lessons for the next project.

CHAPTER 6: CONCLUSIONS AND RECOMMENDATIONS

6.1 Conclusions

The Productivity Suite and Budget Tracking Application actually hits all its main goals:

1. ***Integrated Environment***: Pulled together task management, time tracking, and budget planning into a single app.
2. ***User-Friendly Interface***: The dark theme looks sharp, and getting around the app feels smooth and straightforward.
3. ***Everything Works***: All the basics—CRUD operations, Pomodoro timer, PDF export, analytics—they’re all up and running.
4. ***Tech Specs Met***: It works across different platforms, responds in under two seconds, and keeps your data stored locally.
5. ***Educational Value***: Shows off real-world use of Python, PyQt5, SQLite, and some data visualization tools.

Honestly, this project shows you don’t need a bunch of separate apps when you can just roll everything into one solid tool.

6.2 Limitations

1. ***Single-User Only***: You can’t share or collaborate with others.
2. ***Local Storage***: There’s no cloud backup or way to sync across devices.
3. ***Basic Features***: Some things are missing—no recurring tasks, reminders, or budget forecasting.
4. ***No Mobile Version***: Stuck on desktop, so you can’t take it everywhere.

5. **Limited Customization:** Dark theme only, and not much else you can tweak.

6.3 Recommendations

6.3.1 For Users

- Track your personal productivity with the app.
- Export PDF reports on a regular basis to keep up with your finances.
- For backup, just drop those files into cloud storage like Dropbox.
- Stick with the Pomodoro timer—it actually helps you stay focused.

6.3.2 For Future Development

Short-term Improvements:

Let's start simple. Add an option to import and export data. Set up reminders and notifications, too. Toss in a few more chart types and analytics, and basic budget planning features. These tweaks make the app more useful right away.

Medium-term Enhancements:

Next, build a mobile companion app so folks can stay productive on the go. Cloud sync comes in handy here—keep everything updated across devices. Organize tasks with categories and tags. And let users attach pictures of receipts to track expenses better.

Long-term Vision:

Looking ahead, imagine AI-powered productivity tips built in. Add team collaboration features, so people can work together. Connect with other apps like Google Calendar or banking APIs. And bring in advanced financial planning tools for those who want more depth.

6.3.3 For Educational Purposes

This project works great as a teaching example for Python GUI development. You can extend it with extra modules if you want to dig deeper. The code's structure gives students a clear look at how to build an app from the ground up. Plus, it's flexible—you can tweak it for different uses, like a student planner or a freelance tracker.

6.4 Final Assessment

The Productivity Suite nails its goal as a proof-of-concept. It pulls together a bunch of productivity tools into one spot and really shows off what Python can do for desktop apps. User-centered design stands out here, making the software actually useful for real people. Local data privacy is baked in, which matters for personal apps.

Sure, it's not something you'd sell out of the box, but it's a solid starting point for personal use and future upgrades. The project does a great job connecting academic theory with practical work. You see how classroom concepts turn into real software.

Bottom line: the app is ready for anyone looking for a solid, personal productivity tool—and it's got plenty of room to grow.

CHAPTER 7: REFERENCES

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3. Sommerville, I. (2016). Software Engineering, 10th Edition. Pearson.

This project sticks to the guidelines set by New Horizons Computer Learning Centers. It pulls from best practices in software engineering and insights from human-computer interaction research to keep things on track.

GitHub Repository: <https://github.com/LR-Hyzik07/Productivity-suite>